

irony though there is that human hearing is only between 20 Hz and 20 kHz, and decreases with your age. This doesn't necessarily mean that all the extra bandwidth and information is useless. Headphones capable of playing the full spectrum, will obviously be able to play back the part you hear more completely without any notes getting clipped.

Therefore, in theory, high res headphones should sound better but it's not as simple as that. Ultimately how good a pair of headphones are depends on a number of factors including the balance, dynamics and timing.

So the answer to the question asked above is- no, in most cases a 'high-res' headphone like the Sony 1000X, won't necessarily sound better than any other pair of great headphones from the pre hi-res era like Sennheiser HD 700 for example.



JAS and CTA started developing the high resolution audio standard in 2014

High-Res file formats and where to get High-Res music from

There is no industry standard for high resolution file formats right now and any format capable of lossless compression beyond the 44.1 kHz/16 bit resolution is good enough. Though there are a number of formats out there including WAV, AIFF and DSD, FLAC (Free lossless audio codec) and ALAC (Apple lossless audio codec) are the most common ones.



FLAC and ALAC are the most commonly used high-res file format

If you have decided that you want to set up a high resolution audio rig, then the next question that will come to your mind is, 'where do I get high res music from?'

There are a number of online stores that sell these. Following is a list of the best ones:

- www.hdtracks.com – The first music store to provide high resolution songs for download, HDtracks has partnered with almost every major record label and has probably the world's largest collection of high resolution audio files.
- www.7digital.com – It has a very good catalogue that also includes classical and jazz music, and a nice interface to the site.